

efficiency. Under these regulations, the government mandates specific energy consumption limits for fans, effectively making older, less efficient fans obsolete. For instance, a 1.2-metre (48-inch) ceiling fan can now consume a maximum of 57.5 watts while delivering the market required 230CMM airflow, to meet the new standards, significantly lower than the 75-80 watts of older models.

Manufacturers and well-known brands proactively prepared for these regulations even before their enforcement, partly due to the impact of Covid-19, which resulted in a two-year delay in their implementation.

The key factors driving this shift include a government push for energy efficiency through labelling, consumer demand for eco-friendly appliances, and a desire to reduce energy consumption, which can be especially important for those considering solar panel installations. While some older AC induction motor fans have been able to meet the new standards by reducing airflow and thereby lowering power consumption, BLDC fans offer a more consistent and efficient solution, delivering the desired airflow while maintaining a five-star energy rating.

The shift to more efficient fans is not without its questions, as some wonder why older fans couldn't have been made more efficient earlier. The answer lies in the trade-off between power consumption and airflow, a challenge that BLDC fans effectively address by delivering both efficiency and performance. These factors collectively contribute to the changing landscape of fan technology and energy consumption in India.

What is the difference between active BLDC, BLDC, and inverter fans?

It's important to recognise that

the term "BLDC fan" has been somewhat commodified and used as a marketing gimmick in the industry. Manufacturers often label their fans with terms like "active BLDC," "inverter fans," and so on to differentiate their products. However, what truly sets our journey apart is that since 2013, we have worked closely with government bodies such as the Bureau of Energy Efficiency (BEE), BIS (Bureau of Indian Standards), and ESL (Energy



Efficiency Services Limited) to demonstrate that efficient fans like ours are not just a concept but a viable reality in the market. Through this collaboration, the government recognised the need for greater fan energy efficiency and introduced stricter efficiency ratings. They made it mandatory for fans to have BEE star labelling, similar to air-conditioners. Starting from January 1, 2023, fans are now categorised with star labels, ranging from one star (least efficient) to five stars (most efficient), mirroring the system used for air-conditioners.

As a result, all major players in the fan industry had to adapt to these new regulations and introduce super-efficient fans in their product portfolios. Many of them sourced technology from various suppliers and started manufacturing their efficient fan models. Some adopted terms like 'inverter quality' or 'ac-

tive BLDC' to differentiate themselves in marketing their products. While the terminology may vary, the goal remains the same: providing energy-efficient fans to consumers.

What has prompted you to scale now, after a decade?

Until 2017, we held a dominant position in the market, essentially serving as the major player. Others existed, but their market presence and volume were relatively limited during that period. It's important to note that the market wasn't prepared for rapid expansion during those years. Our company, with a history spanning about 30 to 32 years, has always been rooted in technology. We approached every aspect of our business with a tech-centric perspective.

However, there were specific reasons for our cautious approach. Firstly, the market readiness played a significant role. We refrained from aggressive expansion when the market conditions weren't conducive for such growth. This strategy allowed us to maintain stability.

During the intervening years, notably the recent period marked by semiconductor component shortages, we deliberately scaled back our expansion efforts. Our other motor control products rely heavily on semiconductor components, and the challenges surrounding their availability prompted this strategic decision. As a result, we concentrated on serving a stable customer base.

This strategy did come with challenges, and there may have been some errors along the way. However, it was a conscious choice, given the market conditions and our resource allocation. Now, with a more mature market and examples of successful scaling combined with our unique core technology, we are poised to expand differently. **EFY**